

SCAR

written by

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INT. AVERYS STAIRS - EARLY MORNING

LUGGAGE rolls, BANGS on the stairs. Thud! Screech!

KYLE (O.S.)
Pick it up and get going.

INT. AVERYS STAIRS - FOYER

The FOYER of the AVERYS house is a standard looking box with a CLOSET, STAIRWELL, and GAUDY DECORATIONS.

PATRICK (10 yrs, boy) half-asleep looks up to KYLE (40s, father) who is directing his kids forward like a sailor on an AIR CRAFT CARRIER.

KYLE
Everyone has to carry their own
luggage. If it's too heavy, then
put something back. We hit the road
in ten minutes.

Kyle moves into the hallway to SEARCH for his last child.
Patrick turns and from his father towards the STAIRS.

PATRICK
Eighteen up. Eighteen down. Easier
to cut my losses and go to the van.

Patrick turns and exits the FOYER into the 5 am darkness.

EXT. AVERYS PORCH AND FRONT YARD - EARLY MORNING

The 5 AM MOON hangs in the sky. STREETLIGHTS are on. Patrick slowly moves towards the VAN in the driveway.

ALICIA (O.S.)
[yawn]

Patrick stops and corners his ALICIA (14 yrs, girl, blue pajamas) breeze past him.

PATRICK
That sounds pleasant at five in the
morning-

Alicia continues walking.

ALICIA
Nothing is pleasant before the
sun's up. I don't do well in the
morning. Or the afternoon.
(MORE)

ALICIA (CONT'D)
Or the evening. Frankly, sleeping
is when I peak.

Patrick glances back at Kyle locking the door. Kyle double checks each lock.

INTO VIEW: Alicia stares at the open van door. She struggles to lift her luggage. She glances up to see MASON (15yrs, boy) sitting in the middle seat staring, SMILING at his sister. He doesn't move.

ALICIA (V.O.)
You're not helpful.

Alicia wheels her luggage to the back of the van, leaves it for Kyle, then returns to the side of the van. She steps inside as Mason returns himself to be under a blanket with headphones over his head. Alicia moves to open back seat. She settles in as her luggage get DROPPED to her side.

ALICIA
You could have helped me. Fine! Be
that way!

Rachel from the front passenger seat, turns to see Alicia.

RACHEL
What'd you say dear?

ALICIA
Nothing mom. Just talking to
myself.

Alicia leans back as a second piece of luggage is dropped onto her head. The REAR van door is shut. She notices Patrick take his seat as Kyle moves aside the van to the drivers seat.

ANGLE ON: Kyle quickly gets set. He checks his rear-view mirror.

KYLE
(inside voice)
One kid. Two kid. Three kid.
(glancing at his wife)

RACHEL
Finish that thought. It'll be your
last.

Rachel inhales the FRENCH VANILLA LATTE. She enjoys the peace.

RACHEL (CONT'D)
I gave the bathroom speech.

KYLE
Good. I want to make the Mason-Dixon before we stop anywhere.

RACHEL
I'm hoping for Virginia. Patrick is set with his game. Mason has a growth on his head so I guess he's fine. Alicia! How are you?

ANGLE ON (OTS): Alicia smiles at her mom as she digs MICHAEL'S BASEBALL CAP out of the bag.

ALICIA
I've got the yawns. Aside from that I'm good. Got a grab bag of snacks with me.

KYLE
Alright kids. Destination Savannah or bust.

Kyle drives the van OFF the driveway. Alicia glances out the window, sees a GOLF TEE MAILBOX.

ALICIA (V.O.)
Michael's sister to the rescue. He won't be needing this all Summer.

Alicia glances down at the hand twisting in her hand.

ALICIA (V.O.) (CONT'D)
Ha, county will be telling you where you can be in the Summer. Time to say good night to my roadies and get some sleep because I've got some mind traveling to do.

INT. COURT OF COMMON PLEAS, YORK COUNTY, PA - MORNING

A COURT HOUSE with wooden beams like a barn; more paintings than a museum; and marble walls. The room is FULL of ATTORNEYS, PARENTS, and the VANDALS.

MICHAEL (14yrs, suit and tie) sits on a bench. LIZ (14yrs, dressed for success) is staring at her phone. Daniel (14 yrs, jeans and button top) is staring at the ceiling. TRAVIS NOBLE (14 yrs, suit) is leaning against a wall. CHARLES (16 yrs, suit) is pacing the room.

ALICIA (V.O.)

This place is a little spiffier
than I thought it'd be. I figured
there'd be jail cells, men in zebra
print uniforms with handcuffs and
dogs in police uniforms keeping the
peace. Guess the law isn't
everything it's cracked up to be.

DANIEL

(to his sister)

I never thought we'd get turned in.
It was the perfect plan. Only a few
people knew. We all agreed not to
say anything. Who knew it was gonna
go wrong?

MICHAEL

None of us did.

ALICIA (V.O.)

You should have thought it was
possible.

MICHAEL

Guess it could be worse. We could
be in jail or juvenile hall, which
according to the internet is
basically the same thing.

Charles paces, glancing from vandal to vandal. His face is
red with anger.

CHARLES

We could also be free. Perhaps if
you had told me what you were
doing, I wouldn't be here.

Charles speaks with his hands, flailing them into the air and
flinging them around as he paints a picture in mid-air.

CHARLES (CONT'D)

I mean, look at yourself
Travis. You took bars of soap and
wrote Edgar Allen Poe stories on
the school windows.

EVERYONE in ear-shot chuckles at Charles proclamation.

CHARLES (CONT'D)

Oh Romeo, my fair Romeo! Why arst
thou at the Principal's window?

TRAVIS

That's Shakespeare, not Poe.

CHARLES

Does it matter? We-

(pause)

- no you got caught. And now I'm here! It's eight in the morning on a Summer day when we don't have school. I should be sleeping right now.

CLOSE ON: Michael glances down at the hat in his hands then he turns towards Liz who is still staring at her phone.

MICHAEL

Hey president, how'd you get...Did you figure out why your mom turned us in?

ALICIA

Liz looks bitter. I wouldn't bother her if I was you; I'm not, but I am in your mind so I don't really want to watch you die. Oh, there's a 3 on her face now. Good! I hope the judge throws the book at all of you. Hope it's a heavy book too, like an encyclopedia series!

LIZ

I asked my mom. She just stood there smiling, shrugging her shoulders and went back to watching television. No explanation. Just a cold shoulder.

CHARLES

At-least your dad isn't a cop. I'll be hearing about this one forever. You gave me money and a list. How was I to know what the four of you would be doing? Did you not think you might get caught vandalizing the school?

LIZ

Thought about it. Thinking about it more now that we did get caught. But what did you think the order of soap, toilet paper and forks were going to be used for? Didn't you learn to think in high school?

DANIEL
He's only in his second year-

TRAVIS
-Sounds like he might need to repeat it. I told you Alicia knew. Everyone knows who we are.

MICHAEL
Everyone did know. It was online.

A moment of silence, then Charles notices Daniel is making a mess at the water fountain.

CHARLES
Why did you just splash so much water on your face? Or any water for that matter?

CLOSE ON: Daniel has water dripping down his face as he wipes the water with his sleeve.

DANIEL
Sympathy. If the judge sees me crying maybe, he'll be lenient. I don't want to lose my Summer just because of a prank. That would be unreasonable.

TRAVIS
Chuck! It's like Liz said. What'd you think Michael needed sixteen rolls of toilet paper at one time?

ALICIA (V.O.)
Sixteen rolls equals vandalism or a medical emergency. Don't want to be on the end of either of those options. Enjoy your Summer boys, girls and Chuck! Mine is heading South for greener pastures.

INT. AVERYS VAN - NOON

Patrick glances up from his video game. He notices Mason and Alicia asleep. He looks out the window of the VAN on the highway to see the BLUE RIDGE MOUNTAINS.

PATRICK
There are lots of trees out here.

Kyle steadies himself in the seat. He smiles and checks the rearview mirror to see Patrick.

KYLE
We're in the Blue Ridge
Mountains. They run for over a
hundred miles.

PATRICK
Trees don't look blue. They're as
green as the ones back home.

KYLE
If you squint your eyes-

RACHEL
-Dear.

PATRICK
Dad, are we there yet?

Kyle smiles an 8. He taps his fingers as the sound of a
FIDDLE AND BRASS band PLAYS through the speakers. Kyle turns
up the volume to DROWN out his son.

INT. AVERYS VAN - AFTERNOON

Patrick stares out the window to see the VAN crossing a low
bridge over a CAROLINA SWAMP.

PATRICK
Dad?

Kyle ignores the question.

RACHEL
Yes, dear.

PATRICK
How many hours is the drive to
Savannah?

RACHEL
Eleven.

PATRICK
So, we're not there yet are we?

RACHEL
No dear, we're not there yet.

Rachel looks at her husband who is SHOWING his STRESS. She
turns the radio dial to the sound of a duel between a PIANO
AND VIOLIN.

INT. AVERYS VAN - EVENING

SIGN "WELCOME TO GEORGIA is aside the highway. Patrick stares to the ceiling of the van.

PATRICK

Dad?

KYLE

No. We are not there yet. No. I don't know how long it'll be. No. I don't have more food.

PATRICK

I gotta pee.

RACHEL

Next exit is three miles. Hold it till then.

Patrick listens to the GOSPEL song on the radio as he sees a GEORGIA PEACH ORCHARD aside the highway.

EXT. BARON ROADWAY - LATER AFTERNOON

ANGLE UP: Staring into the SPANISH MOSS hanging from a MAGNOLIA TREE in SAVANNAH in JUNE. The humidity is visible in the air. ASIDE the roadway, a sidewalk meets a tall STONE WALL.

Kyle's FINGERTIPS run along the YELLOW SPECKS of POLLEN that covered the wall grout. He smiles at he meets and ORNATE BLACK GATE. Looking right, he sees ALICIA failing to walk off a leg that is asleep while pulling her SUITCASE and carrying her DUFFLE BAG; Patrick is turning in circles; and Mason approaches his position with sweat on his BROW. He stares past the gate to the LARGE SOUTHERN HOME, HALF STAIRS that lead to a RAISED CIRCULAR PORCH and FRONT DOOR.

KYLE

(mumbling)

Yeah, this house is bigger than ours. We can fit two houses in this one home.

MASON

Nope!

(laughing)

I don't know what you're mumbling. But nope is the answer. Just putting my two cents into the conversation. Make it worth something.

Rachel laughs as she passes Kyle and turns into the open GATE held by Mason. She takes in the view of the garden to LEFT. A garden with a RED STRIPED LIGHTHOUSE, TALL SUNFLOWERS, and a BLUE HOUSE (1800s, pitched roof with Attic window).

ANGLE ON: Rachel steps up the circular steps to the front door. She looks back as her kids WANDER up and KYLE wanders away from the front door. She waits for the kids, then rings the doorbell. RING. RING. RING.

A moment passes.

The front door swings open, revealing a foyer with fourteen feet high ceilings, crown molding and a special sweet smell that all the AVERYS INHALE.

INTO VIEW: DAPHNE (14 yrs, 5'2", niece to Rachel) stands in the doorway with an SMILE.

DAPHNE

Welcome to Savannah! Come on in.
Mum is making a treat for you to
finish the drive. I'd recommend
taste testing the chocolate covered
strawberries. I picked them from
the garden yesterday. The
strawberries, not the chocolate
which came from the store.

JOLENE (O.S.)

Down the hall to the right!

RACHEL

Love the place-

Rachel gets a HUG from Daphne then continues down the hall way. Daphne turns to Mason, then Patrick, then Mason.

DAPHNE

Boys. Bathroom down the hall and
another upstairs, second door on
left.

Patrick and Mason bolt past their cousin with Patrick running the hallway and Mason running up the stairs. Daphne turns to Alicia.

DAPHNE (CONT'D)

Hug?

ALICIA

Of course.

Alicia and Daphne hug, step back.